

Modern History facts 🇮🇳🇮🇳🇮🇳

Advent of Europeans

1. Vasco da Gama reached Calicut in 1498.
 2. Portuguese were the first Europeans to establish trade in India.
 3. Portuguese main base in India was Goa.
 4. They introduced the cartaz (naval pass) system.
 5. Dutch East India Company was formed in 1602.
 6. Dutch focused mainly on spice trade.
 7. English East India Company was established in 1600.
 8. First English factory was set up at Surat.
 9. Battle of Swally (1612) gave British trade rights.
 10. French East India Company was founded in 1664.
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British Expansion

11. Battle of Plassey was fought in 1757.
 12. Siraj-ud-Daulah was defeated in Plassey.
 13. Mir Jafar betrayed Siraj-ud-Daulah.
 14. Battle of Buxar was fought in 1764.
 15. British defeated Mughal emperor and Nawab of Awadh in Buxar.
 16. Shah Alam II granted Diwani rights.
 17. Diwani gave British right to collect revenue in Bengal.
 18. Dual Government was introduced in Bengal.
 19. Robert Clive started Dual Government.
 20. British became real rulers after Buxar.
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Regulating & Charter Acts

21. Regulating Act was passed in 1773.
 22. It made Governor of Bengal → Governor-General.
 23. Supreme Court was set up at Calcutta in 1774.
 24. Pitt's India Act was passed in 1784.
 25. It created Board of Control.
 26. Charter Act 1813 ended trade monopoly (except tea).
 27. Charter Act 1833 ended all company trade.
 28. Charter Act 1833 made Governor-General of India.
 29. Charter Act 1853 introduced open competition for civil services.
 30. Legislative and executive functions were separated in 1853.
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Governor-Generals

31. Warren Hastings was first Governor-General.
 32. Lord Cornwallis introduced Permanent Settlement.
 33. Lord Wellesley introduced Subsidiary Alliance.
 34. Lord Bentinck abolished Sati in 1829.
 35. Lord Dalhousie introduced Doctrine of Lapse.
 36. Dalhousie promoted railways and telegraph.
 37. Doctrine of Lapse annexed Jhansi and Satara.
 38. British expanded maximum under Dalhousie.
 39. Western education was promoted during British rule.
 40. English became medium of education.
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Land Revenue Systems

41. Permanent Settlement was introduced in Bengal.
 42. Zamindars were made landowners.
 43. Revenue was fixed permanently.
 44. Ryotwari system was introduced in Madras & Bombay.
 45. Thomas Munro introduced Ryotwari.
 46. Farmers paid tax directly to government.
 47. Mahalwari system was introduced in North India.
 48. Holt Mackenzie introduced Mahalwari.
 49. Village (Mahal) was revenue unit.
 50. These systems led to peasant exploitation.
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Anglo-Mysore, Maratha & Sikh Wars

51. Anglo-Mysore wars were fought between British & Mysore.
 52. Haider Ali was first strong ruler of Mysore.
 53. Tipu Sultan died in 1799.
 54. Fourth Anglo-Mysore War ended Mysore power.
 55. Anglo-Maratha wars ended Maratha dominance.
 56. Three Anglo-Maratha wars were fought.
 57. Anglo-Sikh wars led to annexation of Punjab.
 58. Punjab was annexed in 1849.
 59. British became supreme power after these wars.
 60. Indian states gradually lost independence.
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Revolt of 1857

61. Revolt started in Meerut in 1857.
62. Immediate cause was greased cartridges issue.
63. Mangal Pandey sparked revolt.
64. Bahadur Shah II was declared leader.

65. Rani Lakshmibai fought bravely.
66. Nana Sahib led revolt in Kanpur.
67. Revolt spread to North and Central India.
68. It failed due to lack of unity.
69. Modern weapons were lacking.
70. It ended Company rule.

After 1857

71. Government of India Act 1858 was passed.
72. British Crown took control of India.
73. Viceroy replaced Governor-General.
74. Lord Canning was first Viceroy.
75. Policy of non-interference in religion adopted.
76. Army was reorganized.
77. Ratio of British soldiers increased.
78. Divide and rule policy started.
79. Princely states were protected.
80. Direct Crown rule began.

Socio-Religious Reform

81. Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded Brahmo Samaj.
82. He opposed Sati and child marriage.
83. Dayanand Saraswati founded Arya Samaj.
84. Arya Samaj promoted "Back to Vedas."
85. Swami Vivekananda founded Ramakrishna Mission.
86. He spoke at Chicago Parliament (1893).
87. Sir Syed Ahmad Khan started Aligarh Movement.
88. He promoted modern education among Muslims.
89. Reform movements improved social conditions.
90. Women education was encouraged.

INC & Freedom Struggle

91. Indian National Congress was founded in 1885.
92. A.O. Hume played key role.
93. Moderates believed in petitions.
94. Extremists promoted boycott and swadeshi.
95. Partition of Bengal happened in 1905.
96. Bal Gangadhar Tilak said "Swaraj is my birthright."
97. Mahatma Gandhi led mass movements.
98. Non-Cooperation Movement started in 1920.
99. Civil Disobedience Movement started in 1930.
100. Quit India Movement was launched in 1942.

Gandhian Movements & National Struggle

101. Mahatma Gandhi returned to India in 1915.

102. His first movement was Champaran Satyagraha (1917).
103. Champaran movement was related to indigo farmers.
104. Kheda Satyagraha (1918) was for tax relief.
105. Ahmedabad Mill Strike (1918) was for workers' rights.
106. Rowlatt Act was passed in 1919.
107. It allowed detention without trial.
108. Jallianwala Bagh Massacre occurred on April 13, 1919.
109. General Dyer ordered firing.
110. Rabindranath Tagore returned his knighthood in protest.

Non-Cooperation Movement

111. Non-Cooperation Movement started in 1920.
112. It was against British rule and Rowlatt Act.
113. Khilafat Movement supported it.
114. Ali Brothers led Khilafat Movement.
115. People boycotted schools, courts, and goods.
116. Chauri Chaura incident happened in 1922.
117. Police station was burned by protestors.
118. Gandhi withdrew the movement after violence.
119. It marked first mass movement.
120. Swaraj became a mass demand.

Revolutionary Movements

121. Bhagat Singh threw bomb in Central Assembly.
122. Chandrashekhar Azad led HSRA.
123. HSRA = Hindustan Socialist Republican Association.
124. Kakori Conspiracy (1925) involved train robbery.
125. Ram Prasad Bismil was leader in Kakori case.
126. Saunders was killed by Bhagat Singh.
127. "Inquilab Zindabad" slogan became popular.
128. Revolutionaries believed in armed struggle.
129. Their aim was complete independence.
130. Many were executed by British.

Civil Disobedience Movement

131. Civil Disobedience Movement started in 1930.
132. Salt March began from Sabarmati Ashram.
133. Gandhi walked to Dandi (240 miles).
134. Salt law was broken on April 6, 1930.
135. It spread across India.
136. Gandhi-Irwin Pact was signed in 1931.
137. Second Round Table Conference held in London.

- 138. Movement restarted after failure.
- 139. Women actively participated.
- 140. It weakened British authority.

Constitutional Developments

- 141. Morley-Minto Reforms introduced separate electorates.
- 142. Muslims got separate representation.
- 143. Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms introduced dyarchy.
- 144. Subjects divided into transferred & reserved.
- 145. Government of India Act 1935 was most comprehensive.
- 146. Provincial autonomy was introduced.
- 147. Federal structure was proposed.
- 148. Reserve Bank of India was established (1935).
- 149. Federal Court was established in 1937.
- 150. It became base for Indian Constitution.

Quit India Movement

- 151. Quit India Movement started in 1942.
- 152. Launched at Bombay session of Congress.
- 153. Gandhi gave slogan "Do or Die."
- 154. Leaders were arrested immediately.
- 155. Movement became leaderless.
- 156. It spread violently in many areas.
- 157. Parallel governments were formed.
- 158. British suppressed movement brutally.
- 159. It showed mass anger against British.
- 160. It was final mass struggle.

Subhas Chandra Bose & INA

- 161. Subhas Chandra Bose formed Forward Bloc.
- 162. He escaped from India in 1941.
- 163. Indian National Army (INA) was formed.
- 164. INA was originally formed by Rash Behari Bose.
- 165. Bose reorganized INA.
- 166. Slogan: "Give me blood, I will give you freedom."
- 167. INA fought with Japanese support.
- 168. INA trials created national sympathy.
- 169. Women regiment named Rani Jhansi Regiment.
- 170. Bose died in 1945 (air crash, debated).

Towards Independence

- 171. Cripps Mission failed.
- 172. It proposed dominion status after war.
- 173. Wavell Plan failed due to differences.
- 174. Shimla Conference (1945) was unsuccessful.

- 175. Cabinet Mission proposed federation.
- 176. It suggested grouping of provinces.
- 177. Interim Government formed in 1946.
- 178. Jawaharlal Nehru became head.
- 179. Muslim League demanded Pakistan.
- 180. Direct Action Day (1946) led to riots.

Independence & Partition

- 181. Lord Mountbatten announced partition plan.
- 182. Indian Independence Act passed in 1947.
- 183. India became independent on August 15, 1947.
- 184. Pakistan was created as separate nation.
- 185. Cyril Radcliffe drew boundary line.
- 186. It is called Radcliffe Line.
- 187. Massive migration occurred.
- 188. Communal riots caused heavy loss of life.
- 189. Princely states were integrated later.
- 190. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel led integration.

Important Miscellaneous Facts

- 191. Vernacular Press Act was passed in 1878.
- 192. Ilbert Bill controversy happened in 1883.
- 193. Hunter Commission was on education.
- 194. Swadeshi Movement started after Bengal partition.
- 195. Home Rule Movement started in 1916.
- 196. Annie Besant led Home Rule Movement.
- 197. Lucknow Pact (1916) united Congress & League.
- 198. Simon Commission came in 1927.
- 199. "Simon Go Back" slogan was raised.
- 200. Poona Pact (1932) between Gandhi and B.R. Ambedkar.

■ 1. Advent of Europeans in India

◆ Portuguese

- In 1498, Vasco da Gama reached Calicut (Kerala) via the Cape of Good Hope sea route, opening direct trade between Europe and India.
- The Portuguese established their first stronghold at Goa in 1510 under Afonso de Albuquerque, which later became their capital in India.
- They introduced the **cartaz system**, a naval pass system to control Indian Ocean trade and ensure monopoly over maritime commerce.
- Major centers included Goa, Daman, Diu, and Cochin, mainly focused on spice trade and missionary activities.
- Their decline began in the 17th century due to corruption, weak administration, and strong competition from the Dutch and British.

◆ Dutch (VOC)

- The Dutch East India Company (VOC) was established in 1602 and entered India mainly to control the lucrative spice trade of Southeast Asia.
- They established trading posts at Pulicat (Tamil Nadu), Nagapattinam, and Cochin after defeating the Portuguese in some regions.
- Unlike the British, the Dutch focused more on trade than territorial expansion, limiting their political influence in India.
- They were finally defeated by the British in the **Battle of Bedara (1759)** in Bengal, marking the end of Dutch dominance in India.

◆ English (British)

- The British East India Company was established in 1600 by a royal charter of Queen Elizabeth I.
- The first English factory was set up at Surat in 1613 after gaining permission from Mughal Emperor Jahangir.
- In 1612, the British defeated the Portuguese in the **Battle of Swally (near Surat)**, which strengthened their position in India.
- They later established major centers at Madras (1639), Bombay (1668), and Calcutta (1690), forming the base of British power.
- Over time, the company shifted from trade to territorial control, especially after gaining political power in Bengal.

◆ French

- The French East India Company was established in 1664 under the guidance of Jean-Baptiste Colbert during the reign of Louis XIV.
- The French established major centers at Pondicherry, Chandernagore, Mahe, and Karaikal.
- Under Dupleix, the French tried to expand political influence in South India.
- They fought a series of **Carnatic Wars (1746–1763)** against the British for control over South India.
- The French were ultimately defeated by the British, leading to British supremacy in India.

■ 2. Expansion of British Power in India

◆ Battle of Plassey (1757)

- The Battle of Plassey was fought on June 23, 1757, near Plassey (Palashi) in Bengal between the British East India Company and Siraj-ud-Daulah.
- The British forces were led by Robert Clive.
- The Nawab's commander Mir Jafar betrayed him during the battle, leading to a decisive British victory.
- This battle marked the beginning of British political control in India, as Mir Jafar was made the puppet Nawab of Bengal.

◆ Battle of Buxar (1764)

- The Battle of Buxar was fought in 1764 at Buxar (Bihar) between the British and a combined force of Shah Alam II, the Nawab of Awadh, and Mir Qasim.
- The British army, led by Hector Munro, defeated the combined Indian forces decisively.
- This victory strengthened British control over Bengal and marked the real beginning of British territorial empire in India.

◆ Diwani Rights (1765)

- In 1765, Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II granted the Diwani rights (right to collect revenue) of Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa to the British East India Company.
- This allowed the company to collect taxes directly from the people, making it economically powerful.

- It marked the transition of the company from a trading body to a political and administrative power.
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◆ Dual Government in Bengal

- Introduced by Robert Clive in 1765 in Bengal.
 - Under this system, the British controlled revenue collection, while the Nawab was responsible for administration.
 - This led to poor governance, corruption, and severe famines (notably the Bengal Famine of 1770).
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■ 3. Regulating Act 1773 & Pitt's India Act 1784

◆ Regulating Act 1773

- It was the first attempt by the British Parliament to regulate the affairs of the East India Company in India.
 - The Governor of Bengal was made the Governor-General of Bengal, with Warren Hastings as the first holder of this position.
 - A Supreme Court was established at Calcutta in 1774 to administer justice.
 - The act aimed to control corruption but had limitations due to unclear powers.
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◆ Pitt's India Act 1784

- This act established a system of dual control between the British government and the East India Company.
 - A Board of Control was created in Britain to supervise political affairs in India.
 - It reduced the company's autonomy and increased government control over Indian administration.
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■ 4. Charter Acts (1813, 1833, 1853)

◆ Charter Act 1813

- It ended the East India Company's monopoly over trade with India, except for tea and trade with China.
- It allowed Christian missionaries to enter India, leading to the spread of Western education and ideas.

◆ Charter Act 1833

- It made the Governor-General of Bengal the Governor-General of India, centralizing administration.

- It ended all commercial activities of the East India Company, making it purely administrative.
- A Law Commission was appointed under Macaulay to codify Indian laws.

◆ Charter Act 1853

- It introduced open competition for recruitment to the Indian Civil Services (ICS).
 - It separated the legislative and executive functions of the Governor-General's council.
 - It was the last charter act before the Revolt of 1857.
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■ 5. Governor-Generals & Their Policies

- Warren Hastings (1772–1785) introduced judicial reforms and reorganized administration in Bengal.
- Lord Cornwallis (1786–1793) introduced the Permanent Settlement and civil service reforms.
- Lord Wellesley (1798–1805) introduced the Subsidiary Alliance system to expand British control.
- Lord Bentinck (1828–1835) abolished Sati and promoted Western education.
- Lord Dalhousie (1848–1856) introduced Doctrine of Lapse and modernized infrastructure like railways, telegraph, and postal system.

■ 6. Land Revenue Systems

◆ Permanent Settlement (1793)

- Introduced in 1793 in Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa by Lord Cornwallis.
 - Zamindars were declared the legal owners of land and were responsible for collecting revenue from peasants.
 - The revenue demand was fixed permanently, meaning it would not increase in future.
 - While it gave stability to zamindars, it led to heavy exploitation of peasants and frequent evictions.
 - It created a class of absentee landlords and reduced agricultural productivity over time.
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◆ Ryotwari System

- Introduced in Madras and Bombay Presidencies by Thomas Munro in the early 19th century.
- In this system, revenue was collected directly from peasants (ryots), who were recognized as landowners.

- The tax was not fixed permanently and was revised periodically based on soil and productivity.
- Though it removed middlemen, high revenue demands still led to peasant distress and indebtedness.

◆ Mahalwari System

- Introduced in North-Western Provinces, Punjab, and parts of Central India by Holt Mackenzie in 1822.
- Revenue was assessed on entire village (mahal) and collected collectively.
- Periodic revision of revenue took place based on land productivity.
- It often resulted in burden on village communities and encouraged exploitation by local elites.

■ 7. Anglo-Mysore Wars (1767–1799)

- Four wars were fought between the British and Mysore kingdom under Haider Ali and Tipu Sultan.
- The First and Second wars showed strong resistance by Mysore against British expansion in South India.
- In the Third Anglo-Mysore War (1792), Tipu Sultan was defeated and forced to sign the Treaty of Seringapatam.
- The Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799) was fought at Seringapatam, where Tipu Sultan was killed.
- After this, Mysore lost independence and British dominance in South India was firmly established.

■ 8. Anglo-Maratha Wars (1775–1818)

- Three Anglo-Maratha wars were fought between the British and the Maratha Confederacy.
- The First War (1775–1782) ended with the Treaty of Salbai, maintaining status quo.
- The Second War (1803–1805) weakened Maratha power significantly.
- The Third War (1817–1818) led to the final defeat of the Marathas.
- The Peshwa was deposed, and Maratha territories were annexed by the British.
- This marked the end of Maratha dominance and established British supremacy in India.

■ 9. Anglo-Sikh Wars (1845–1849)

- Two Anglo-Sikh wars were fought between the British and the Sikh Empire of Punjab.
- The First War (1845–46) ended with the Treaty of Lahore, reducing Sikh power.
- The Second War (1848–49) resulted in the complete annexation of Punjab by the British.
- The defeat marked the end of the strong Sikh Empire established by Maharaja Ranjit Singh.
- Punjab became an important British province and recruitment center for the army.

■ 10. Revolt of 1857

◆ Causes

- Political: Annexation policies like Doctrine of Lapse created resentment among rulers.
- Economic: Heavy taxation and destruction of traditional industries.
- Social/Religious: Fear of forced conversion and interference in customs.
- Military: Discontent among Indian soldiers due to discrimination and low pay.

◆ Course of Revolt

- The revolt began on May 10, 1857, at Meerut and quickly spread to Delhi, Kanpur, Lucknow, and Jhansi.
- Bahadur Shah II was declared the leader of the revolt in Delhi.
- Major leaders included Rani Lakshmibai, Nana Sahib, and Kunwar Singh.

◆ Results

- The revolt failed due to lack of coordination, unity, and modern weapons.
- It ended the rule of the East India Company in India.
- It led to direct British Crown rule under the Government of India Act 1858.

■ 11. Government of India Act 1858

- Passed after the Revolt of 1857 to transfer power from the East India Company to the British Crown.
- The office of the Governor-General was replaced by the Viceroy, representing the British monarch.
- Lord Canning became the first Viceroy of India.
- A Secretary of State for India was appointed in Britain to control Indian administration.

- The policy of annexation was stopped, and princely states were assured protection.
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■ 12. Socio-Religious Reform Movements

- Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded the Brahmo Samaj in 1828 to oppose social evils like Sati and promote monotheism.
 - Dayanand Saraswati founded the Arya Samaj in 1875, advocating “Back to the Vedas” and social reforms.
 - Swami Vivekananda established the Ramakrishna Mission in 1897, promoting service and spirituality.
 - Sir Syed Ahmad Khan started the Aligarh Movement to promote modern education among Muslims.
 - These movements played a key role in awakening social consciousness and preparing ground for nationalism.
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■ 13. Indian National Congress (Moderate Phase)

- The Indian National Congress was founded in 1885 by A.O. Hume.
 - Early leaders included Dadabhai Naoroji, Surendranath Banerjee, and Gopal Krishna Gokhale.
 - Moderates believed in constitutional methods like petitions, prayers, and meetings.
 - Dadabhai Naoroji presented the **Drain of Wealth Theory**, explaining economic exploitation by the British.
 - Their efforts created political awareness but achieved limited success.
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■ 14. Extremist Phase (1905–1917)

- Leaders included Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, and Lala Lajpat Rai.
 - They promoted aggressive methods like boycott, swadeshi, and national education.
 - The Partition of Bengal in 1905 by Lord Curzon triggered mass protests.
 - Swadeshi Movement encouraged use of Indian goods and boycott of British products.
 - The Surat Split (1907) divided Congress into Moderates and Extremists.
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■ 15. Gandhian Era (1915–1942)

- Mahatma Gandhi introduced mass-based politics using truth and non-violence (Satyagraha).
 - Champaran (1917), Kheda (1918), and Ahmedabad (1918) were his early successful movements.
 - Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–22) aimed at boycotting British institutions but was withdrawn after Chauri Chaura incident.
 - Civil Disobedience Movement (1930–34) began with Dandi March to break salt law.
 - Quit India Movement (1942) was the final mass movement demanding immediate independence.
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■ 16. Constitutional Developments

- Morley-Minto Reforms introduced separate electorates for Muslims.
 - Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms introduced dyarchy in provinces.
 - Government of India Act 1935 introduced provincial autonomy and proposed a federal structure.
 - It also established institutions like the Reserve Bank of India and Federal Court.
 - This act became the foundation for the Indian Constitution.
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■ 17. Towards Independence (1935–1947)

- Cripps Mission offered dominion status after World War II but was rejected.
 - Wavell Plan failed due to disagreement between Congress and Muslim League.
 - Cabinet Mission proposed a federal structure and interim government.
 - Interim Government was formed in 1946 under Jawaharlal Nehru.
 - Communal tensions increased, leading to Direct Action Day (1946) and widespread riots.
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■ 18. Independence & Partition (1947)

- Lord Mountbatten proposed the partition plan in June 1947.
- The Indian Independence Act was passed by British Parliament in July 1947.
- India became independent on August 15, 1947, while Pakistan was created as a separate nation.
- Cyril Radcliffe drew the Radcliffe Line dividing India and Pakistan.

- Partition led to massive migration, communal violence, and loss of lives.
- Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel played a key role in integrating princely states into India.